Grade 8 Geography Worksheet: Map Skills & Atlases

SwotSpot ZA

Section A: Short answer and Definitions [8 Marks]

1. What is the primary purpose of an **atlas index**? [1]

2. Name the three(3) main details usually provided in an index entry after the place name. [3]

3. **Define** what a **map key/legend** is and explain why maps use symbols instead of writing out the full names. [2]

4. What is the rule for the reading order when giving an alpha-numeric grid reference? [2]

Section B: Matching — Symbol Types [3 Marks]

Match each each real world feature in **Column A** with it's correct feature on **Column B**. (Write down the number and the matching letter, e.g. 1-A)

Feature (Column A)	**Symbol Type** (Column B)
1. A national border between two(2) countries	**A.** Area Symbol
2. A dense pine forest reserve	**B.** Point Symbol
3. A historical monument	**C.** Line Symbol

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Section C: Map Scales & Calculations [8 Marks]

1. Name the **three(3) types of map scales** used on maps. [3]

2. A map scale has a Representative Fraction (RF) scale of **1:50 000.**

a) What does **1** represent? [1]

b) Convert 1cm on this map into actual ground distance in **meters**. [1]

c) Convert 1cm on this map into actual ground distance in **kilometers**. [1]

3. If the distance between two towns measured on a 1:50 000 map is 6cm, calculate the real-world distance in **kilometers**. Show your working. [2]

Section D: Scenario & Application [6 Marks]

Study the sample index entry below and answer the questions that follow:

Polokwane . . . . . 18 C2 . . . . . 23°54'S 29°27'E

1. On which **page** of the atlas will you find Polokwane? [1]

2. What is the **alpha-numeric grid reference** for Polokwane on that page? [1]

3. Identify the **column letter** and **row number** where Polokwane is located in that grid. [2]

4. What are the **latitude and longitude coordinates** for Polokwane? [2]